

Concrete Warrior: North Dakota Sales Strategy

Oct 5, 2026 · @JCR

Six weeks to Nov 15. The job is to know this market well enough to answer six questions without hesitating. Every gap below closes the same way: by asking buyers.

If a buyer asked tomorrow, could you answer all six clearly?

What we can say today, and the gap (orange) to close by asking buyers

1. What we own Batch plant, 2 trommels, crusher, 2 mixer trucks ● Owned vs. rented?	2. What we do today First season, \$90K billed, ~50,000 yd topsoil on hand ● One topsoil buyer so far	3. Who we compete with Ready-mix: Knife River only Topsoil: Minot, Williston ● Ask buyers who they use
4. How we earn business Open now, while Knife River is booked until August ● Trucks: 2 of the 6 we need	5. How we win the sale Topsoil: closer, certified, weed-free, they pick up ● Soil report to prove it	6. Top 10 in 12 months Tribe is ~half; 7 can buy this season (below) ● Buyer, timing, approvals

The six answers a buyer would expect

Two businesses, two plays: concrete waits on trucks, topsoil on orders

From the Oct 4 call with Richard. Orange = what's blocking the sale.

Concrete	Topsoil
THE MARKET Knife River is booked until next August. Demand is bigger than supply.	THE MARKET Supply exists, but in Minot and Williston: \$25/yd, uncertified, and trucking kills it.
SELL NOW TO Small jobs that can't wait (~4-5,000 yd), the VFW job (~2,000 yd), Dark Horse	SELL NOW TO Dirt contractors, KSI, reclamation crews. Budgets reloaded Oct 1; they pick it up.
WHAT'S BLOCKING IT Trucks: 2 today, 6 needed. Until then, we can only deliver a few small loads.	WHAT'S BLOCKING IT Orders: one buyer so far. Oil companies need ISNetwork, and our rating is zero.
NEXT MOVE Pick Dodge Center or Evans Trucking this week; meet Dark Horse Tuesday.	NEXT MOVE Call KSI Monday. Dirt contractors answer Mon or Tue. Ask what ISN rating they need.

Concrete vs. topsoil: two different sales plays

Who we think we're up against, by product

From Richard on the Oct 4 call, plus TERO lists and research. Confirm with every buyer.

Ready-mix	Gravel and aggregate	Topsoil
Knife River Only local plant; booked to Aug	Fisher Industries Statewide scale, NDDOT jobs	Sundre Sand and Gravel Named by Richard; trucked in
Minot, Williston, Dickinson 80-90 mi out; mud arrives hot	Knife River Same New Town yard	Gravel Products Minot; Stanley pit
What that means Small jobs have nowhere to go	Triple C, TEK Tribal preference pits	Williston piles \$25/yd, uncertified
	Landowner pits Cheapest fill on road jobs	Operators' own salvage Pads keep their own topsoil
Our edge: open capacity close by while Knife River is booked. Our gaps: trucks, ISNetwork.		

Competitors by product

Richard's top 10 for the next 12 months: the tribe is about half

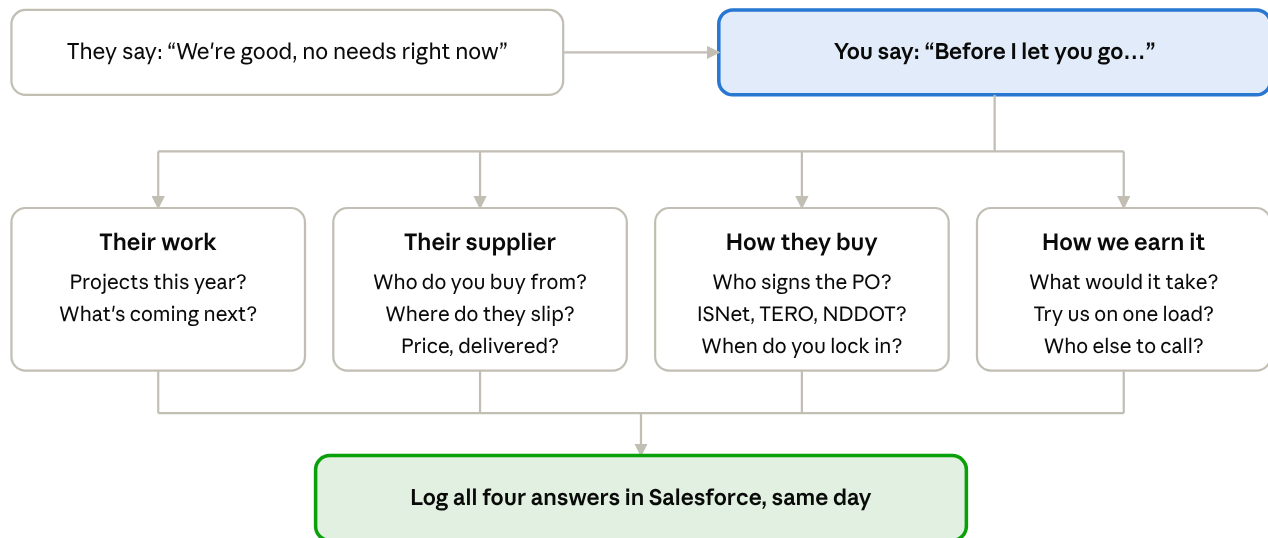
From the Oct 4 call: tribe ~50% of a \$10M year. Volumes are estimates, not orders. Seven can buy now.

	Account	What they'd buy	Can buy now	Opens May 2027
1	MHA Nation and affiliates	~Half of a \$10M year	●	
2	KS Industries	Topsoil; said they'd take all	●	
3	Dark Horse	Concrete: water plants, pads	●	
4	VFW job, New Town (via its GC)	Tear-out + ~2,000 yd concrete	●	
5	Dirt contractors (Badlands, Baranko)	Topsoil; answer Mon or Tue	●	
6	Chord Energy	Gravel, topsoil		●
7	Chevron (Hess)	Gravel, topsoil		●
8	Continental, ConocoPhillips	Gravel, topsoil		●
9	Small jobs: farms, shops	Concrete, ~4-5,000 yd total	●	
10	Reclamation crews (Baker, TEK)	Topsoil	●	

May 2027 = needs ISNetworld first (rating now zero). Also watching: ExxonMobil via KSI, Bison, NDDOT ND 8.

Richard's top 10, next 12 months

A no-needs answer is where the conversation starts



What to ask after a 'no'

This week

- ☐ Trucks: choose Dodge Center or Evans Trucking. Concrete sales wait on this.
- ☐ KSI, Monday: did the Oct 1 money come, and how much will they take?

- ☐ Dark Horse, Tuesday: meet Michael. Why no deposit after two contracts?
- ☐ VFW job: study the plans, bid tear-out plus concrete before the 12th.
- ☐ Dirt contractors: get their topsoil answer by Tuesday.
- ☐ ISNetworld: ask the oil-company contact what rating they need.